

The Anointing of the Believer II

Last week, I could not help but try to teach you into more fellowship with God if I possibly could. I knew nothing else would come out of me. Through the whole early service, the only thing the mind of Christ would move through me in was what Satan wanted.

Lucifer knew what brought God extreme pleasure. Before our creation, in all the different places in heaven, Satan, then known as Lucifer, moved in his beauty. He was deceived by his own brightness, and his wisdom was corrupted by his own beauty.

The instruments of worship, the pipes that were created in him the day he was created, were part of him. He was the sum total, perfect in all his ways. When he would go into a place in heaven where creation was, I imagine, if you know anything about harmony, that is what was created in him as the sum total. He was harmony. He was beauty. He was the anointed cherub that covered.

When he would go into a place or section of heaven, anything God occupied, the beauty and harmony that he would strike, coinciding and coexisting with God as the covering right alongside it, would cause creation to see him and be struck with beauty and worship.

This being, under God and covering, was up until that point the sum total of God's creation and beauty. He saw the great pleasure worship brought the Father. He saw what it brought God as Creator.

The word worship is a word God had to create between created and Creator. It does not work anywhere else. It cannot go on between created and created. Satan found that out. It just cannot.

In the second commandment He says that you will not bow down to images or worship anything created. That word is reserved for Creator.

God, by whom and for whom and through whom all things consist, is more than the One by whom all things exist. Something could exist and then exist through something else later. But Scripture says all things consist. Not only do they exist, but they exist made of something that consists of God. They are created of Him, through Him, for Him, and by Him. All things consist. That is much more than merely exist.

So you will not worship anything created.

This is why Paul, when he received that great revelation in Galatians 3 and 4 about the law being the schoolmaster to the Jew, used that nation to school the whole world. The whole world could see that if the law could not save Israel, then the law could not save anyone.

The law was the schoolmaster for Israel. It was as if the law said, "I have a ruler in my hand. I am the schoolmaster, and I am going to slap you on the hand."

The law was supposed to school Israel in what they needed to inherit from the Father. Paul kept badgering the Jews, saying, in effect, "You want to be under the law? Then hear what I have to say. The servant is no different than the heir."

Because he had been under the law, he could say, "You want to be under the law? Listen to me."

The servant of sin was no different than the heir. They were both under tutors and governors until the time appointed of the Father.

The school had Ten Commandments that said, "You have to keep these, or you are not going to inherit the household of your Father forever." As hard as the Jew sat under the schoolmaster, the Ten Commandments, and tried to perform them, he could not because of his death nature.

In that, the Jew was no different than the common slave of the household, even though he was heir of all. Absolutely no different. He could no more inherit than the slave of sin could inherit, because they were no different. They were also slaves of sin, and the law was the schoolmaster that proved that to them.

They could not do it.

That was the birth of Romans 7. Who could understand that? My God, the apostle Paul. When he finally conceded, he said, "What I would do, I cannot; and what I will not do, I end up doing." Then he gave his conclusion: "It is no longer I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me."

With his mind, he received the Ten Commandments. With everything in him, he tried to keep the commandments of his God. But something working in his members would not let him. That is why he said, "It is no longer I." It was not his will to do those things, but there was a nature in him that would not let him do anything else.

"O wretched man that I am! Who shall deliver me from the body of this death?"

Then he gave his own answer: "I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord."

The Jews were in a peculiar predicament. They had a schoolmaster that said, "You cannot inherit until you can keep this law."

We are not talking about animal sacrifice as though that could solve the problem. Animal sacrifice was part of the works of the law, but Scripture says it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sin, especially the consciousness of sin and the old nature. If they could have done that, they would have ceased to be offered. It was impossible.

All that sacrifice could afford was an operation of accounted righteousness. As long as they operated in it, righteousness was added to their account and charged to the cross. If the cross had never come, all accounted righteousness would have had to come to an end. If Jesus had failed in redemption, everybody in Abraham's bosom would have dropped one degree lower and been in hell itself.

But He did not fail.

He did not fail. He let us out. He let them out. He did not fail. He delivered the new nature.

All those Jews were under the schoolmaster. Then came Jesus, born of a woman and born under the law, according to Galatians 4. Because He was born under the law, He was under obligation to keep the law and fulfill it. And He did.

What made Him different from every other Jew was that He was able to fulfill the law, not by animal sacrifice, but by new nature. He was the first man from Adam who could do it.

Sometimes we confuse the curse of the law. The curse of the law is that a Jew has the Ten Commandments and cannot keep them. That is the curse of it. No matter how hard he tries, no matter how long he waits, he cannot keep it.

Somebody had to become that curse.

Jesus first fulfilled the law, being born of a woman and born under it. He had no choice. Thank God, He was the first one to fulfill it with the new nature. Then, when He had done that, He stepped into the shoes of every Jew who could not and became the curse of the law to free them who were under the curse, so they could receive the adoption of sons.

Now Paul says, "Now that you are sons, why do you want to go back under the weak and beggarly elements of the world and do service to those things which by nature are no gods? You observe days, new moons, and sabbaths. Who has bewitched you, that you would start out in grace and end up under the law?"

The second commandment said you are not going to worship anything created, nor are you going to do service to things that by nature are no gods.

You have been born again. You are His sons and daughters. You belong to His family. You operate now out of that new nature, and you have to do service to no other. He created this word that goes on between created and Creator.

Why would my Father create man and every other creation as such a vast family? What does He want? Why does He want us around Him?

He is self-sufficient, self-consistent, the fullness of everything that is. He is the great I Am: past, present, and future. "I Am" simply means all that there is or ever will be, past, present, and future. He is self-sufficient. He is the consistency of everything that is or ever will be.

What are you doing here?

You are a lot more trouble than we would think you were worth. Then again, we do not think like Him. You were a lot of trouble to redeem.

Hebrews says of the angels, "Who maketh his angels spirits, and his ministers a flame of fire." Each angel came into existence at the hand of God through creation.

Not you.

To the angels, He said He made them spirits and flames of fire. But to the Son He said, "Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee."

The angels were made. The Son was born: "Today Thou art My Son, because today I have begotten Thee."

Keep this in mind: He was the firstborn. There is no use putting a title like firstborn unless somewhere down the line there will be two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, and ten. When you get there, why do you not ask Him what number you were?

The Father actually took from within Himself, not just the consistency of substance that exists and not just creation in the order of angels. Each angel was created, absolutely. But in your order, you were born.

When God formed Adam's body, He formed it out of something that already existed, the dust of the earth. That came from creation from eons before. In the beginning, before anything had a beginning, God created the heavens and the earth. All consistency, all substance, came from the second Person of the Godhead, whom we have fallen in love with as our Redeemer, as Jesus and God. As you know, He was known as the Word. He was Creator. Everything came from Him.

But when it came time for Adam's creation, it says God stopped and breathed. Isn't that interesting? He stopped creating.

Do you think it was a problem for Him to fashion a man's body out of a planet He had placed in the solar system ages before? Do you think it was any problem for Him to take molecules and atoms, rearrange them, set them into working order, and put life in them?

The great technology today is DNA, programming, and changing. They are trying to fight disease by going to the root of it, because they found that DNA operates under such law that if you really want to change something, you go to the beginning of it and change how it is made. They are trying to program disease out, and they are having some success.

Can you imagine God feeding a planet by putting the DNA of a kind into seeds? Strands and strands, just little seeds that do nothing. They do not even know they are there. Get them out of an Egyptian tomb, throw them in soil after four thousand years, and they come to life. One strand after another releases its energy, and after a while, where you only had one seed, you have a whole harvest. And you eat.

God set all of these things into motion.

That is where real prosperity is. We look to God to always do miracles. Real prosperity is being able to put your hand, finger, and wisdom on God's system. If it breaks down, He will step in with a miracle. If they throw you in jail for righteousness' sake and you cannot govern your affairs, He will step in with a miracle.

But if you are always trying to force Him to operate outside the laws He put in place to meet your needs so you can prove He is God, He does not perform like that for you. He does not need proof to know He is God. You should believe what He says in His Word.

God created everything. Spirit existed because God created angel spirits. He has the DNA for spirit. He created them.

After He fashioned Adam's body into something workable, something that could reproduce itself, He stopped and breathed. The word breath means it came from the inside of God, just as your breath represents your life and comes from inside you.

The body without the spirit is dead; literally, the body without the breath is dead. You can understand that.

When God breathed into Adam, He took His very life from inside His Person and put it into him. He took something that already existed as part of Himself.

Think about that. This unravels the mystery when Jesus spoke to Nicodemus.

Nicodemus said, "Must I enter my mother's womb a second time?"

I can just see Jesus looking at him and saying, in effect, "I did not expect you to take anything but a natural view. You need to be born again. You do not have spiritual discernment. You do not even have the capacity to understand Me because you do not have the nature."

Jesus said, "You must be born again, or you will not see the kingdom of heaven."

Nicodemus said, "Must I enter my mother's womb a second time?"

Jesus said, "No. That which is born of the flesh is flesh." You have already been born the first time. That is when your spirit came into existence from the law of Genesis. But then He said, "That which is born of the Spirit is spirit."

Then He explained it:

The wind bloweth where it listeth, and thou hearest the sound thereof, but canst not tell whence it cometh, and whither it goeth: so is every one that is born of the Spirit.

What do you feel like saying? "Thank You very much, Jesus, for explaining this to the spiritually dead man. Thank You so much. Now we can compare our rebirth to something and understand it. Thank You for clearing that mystery up."

The problem is, what did He mean?

The word for wind there is the same kind of word as when God breathed into Adam the breath of life. In the kingdom of heaven, the omnipresence of the Holy Spirit means there is nowhere He is not with the breath of God. In Timbuktu or the lowest places of the earth, you can bow your knee

to the Lord Jesus Christ, and the same breath that was blown into Adam is going to be blown into you. You are going to be made a new creation.

Did God really breathe into Adam? Yes. He took life from inside Himself. Can I prove that to you? What is air made of? Oxygen. If you have H₂O, you have oxygen in it and hydrogen, and you have something like air, but with a thicker consistency: water. Water will move around, but not like air. You cannot compress water. You can get a whole lot of air in a little jar.

Air is a marvelous creation of God. If He does not hold it to the earth with gravity, you and I cannot breathe. But it is just one way we get what this body needs to keep itself alive.

What makes you think God is dependent on anything He created? How could He create something that has to keep Him alive? Do you think God breathes His own creation?

The same way your breath keeps you alive, what keeps your spirit alive is that it came from inside God. The problem is that it never will cease to exist. It only dies in the sense that, because of Adam, we received the sin nature, and we call that death.

You had better get after your friends, because there will never be a time when they will not exist. Where they exist is the choice being made now. How much reward you have is the choice you are making now by what you do with what God gave you to do it with.

I am remembering His Son. I am finding out about the glory Jesus has given me, and to tell you the truth, the devil and everything he reigns over is in trouble.

We were taken from inside God in our original creation. We were born. Then, when we fell, we had to be born again.

No problem. I have been born again. I have had a second infusion of life by the breath of God.

When did you have the first one? In the first man, Adam. When did you have the last one? In the last man, Adam.

I am only reiterating last week's message for a few minutes, but I could see that He was not done.

Worship can only go on between created and Creator. I am in the family of God. I have been born of Him. I am His son, but He is God. Worship can go on between me and Him.

Why did He want me? That is the question. Why did He fill creation with life, and in particular, why with family? Why did He want me? What does He want from me?

If you can figure that out, you can figure out what to give Him.

Hallelujah.

When I begin to give Him what He wants, I am going to learn the meaning of what Jesus said. He said to the Father, "The glory which You gave Me..." Then He turned around, looked at us, and said, "The glory which My Father has given Me, I give unto you."

In His humanity, He said, "Your glory, Father, You gave unto Me." Then Jesus turned to you and said, "My glory I give unto you."

When I figure out what He created me for, it must be something that goes on between created and Creator. Whatever it is He wants from me is what He has always wanted from creation, even before our creation.

Lucifer was the sum total of beauty, harmony, and worship, the anointed cherub that covered, the covering and representation of God. No matter what quadrant he entered into, what part of heaven, what part of conscious created beings, when they saw him, it struck worship into them.

Obviously this brought God something. This fellowship required Him to coin and create a word. You first have to believe there is a Creator for the word to even function for you. It is between you and Him. What goes on between Him and creation is called worship.

We look at it from a created perspective because we cannot understand the One who is the sum total of everything that is. We had a beginning. We are created, so we can only understand half of that word: us to Him.

We think, "He is God, so He has a right to be worshiped." We look at it in legal terms. "He wants this from me. What is He, some kind of egomaniac who wants everybody lying around saying, 'Ah, we worship You. We exalt You. O high One, lofty and lifted up'?"

To tell you the truth, a lot of the attitude projected between created and Creator was developed during man's realm of spiritual death, false religion, and sacrifice. It is not the same thing that goes on between us and Him now that we are His sons and daughters and have this new nature.

Now that you have this nature and you are His sons and daughters, you need to rethink the word worship. You need to understand it further as something between you, who were created, and Him as Creator.

In all religions, we have always understood that we are supposed to get down and pay some kind of homage. Every culture sacrifices something. Some sacrifice their children. Some sacrifice animals. Every time a new El Nino comes along and floods half the world, human sacrifice goes way up in those periods.

In Peru, when they brought children to the tops of the mountains to sacrifice, once the children were old enough to understand what was going on, the harder they cried and bawled, the greater the sacrifice was to their gods.

I understand appeasement. That is almost more how we have taken our creation into sonship: more as appeasement and fear. "I have to give Him these things. He is God, after all."

But you only understand it from your perspective, not from His. Worship can only go on between created and Creator. When you understand what He created you for, which is fellowship, you can re-coin the word worship.

Your worship is received by Him, even with all your lack of knowledge and fears. You are still His sons and daughters. You are His creation. Even when you give Him worship through duty and all kinds of other things, it still works.

What He desires from you in that word worship is better coined as the fellowship and time you spend with Him.

When we start out with our minds, we use statements and phrases of adoration. We say, "I love You. I worship You. I glorify You." Yes, He loves it, and that worship begins to be received. But I can tell you what He is heading for. He is heading for the day He can come and make His abode with you, surround you with a permanent presence, and establish a rapport between you and Him as son and Father.

Then you can carry Him with you in power, healings, miracles, His presence, and the redemption of the rest of creation. All these things go with a person who walks with their Father in such a way that He is present all the time in a rapport flowing with you and all that He is.

That is what He is after.

"I really do not have time."

You would get past the time thing if you found out who He really was, and found out that He is incapable of letting one single need go that you are in fellowship with Him about.

"Then why did it happen?"

It was not Him letting it go. You know that now, do you not? You do not even wonder anymore.

You start this worship as part of what Satan wanted. He had never seen anything bring God pleasure like that. Of course not. Everything consists of Him. Now He has fellowship. Yes, it brings Him great pleasure to interact with His creation.

It brought so much pleasure that this is the one thing Satan wanted. He started diverting it to himself. If you want proof, look at the temptation in the wilderness.

"Look at the kingdoms of the world and the glory of them. Get down and worship me."

He wanted Jesus to get down and worship him.

Three and a half years later, Jesus, the embodiment of God, would kneel before an inferior creation, the race Satan had coaxed into rebellion, death, and even worshiping him. The same Man who would not bow down for the glory of the kingdoms chose the cross. He would not bow to Satan, but He got down on His knees and washed the filth of the trail off an inferior, fallen race of people, and later chose to go to the cross for them.

How do you think Satan felt when he saw what God, in Jesus, was doing with this creation, with what you and I are?

Half of the word worship is my interaction with Him: "I love You. I worship You. I glorify You." His part of the word worship, the better coining of the word, is fellowship: total fellowship and communion with the Father as your Father and you as His son. A total communion, rapport, walk, and fellowship with Him. That is all He wanted from the beginning.

When He first tried to coax me into this kind of worship three years ago or so, every time I say it, it is three or four more months. I saw a rock land in a pond, and the ripples left the rock. One ripple pushed another into every nook and cranny until the whole pond was full of ripples from one rock.

I said, "What was that vision?"

He said, "If you would go home and worship Me all night, you would find out."

Though I did not. A year later, when He slew me in the power, He ordered me into the closet. He knew I would obey then. I found out about it, and I felt extremely dumb for wasting a year.

Nevertheless, I began to understand. When you begin to worship, the rock lands in the pond. That is your spirit. Jesus told the woman that if she drank of that well, it would spring up into everlasting life. That well was the born-again spirit and everything it would bring you.

The Holy Ghost is a river. Your born-again spirit is a well. It will not run out, because it is being fed by the river of God. It cannot and will not run out.

One rock landed in the pond, and pretty soon the fellowship with the Father totally saturated the spirit. I have a lot to say about that. Then those same waves saturated the soul. I call that the baptism of the senses, and it tilted my faith over onto God's side. I won the war of the senses.

The baptism of my senses made me aware of the geographical presence of God around me, until finally came the baptism of my geography. Now I just lift my hands and He comes, and He wants to fill the room.

It was not long after that I found there was healing, faith, and everything in that presence. Everything we look for so hard and try to figure the laws for, I found out He called an anointing. Because it is available to every believer, it is the anointing of the believer.

That means these signs shall follow them that believe. It is for every single believer. This rapport that goes on between you and your Father when He comes and lives with you, and you and Him reconcile the world together, will cause the signs of the believer to follow you like drinking water.

You will lay hands on the sick and they will recover. You will speak with new tongues and cast devils out all day long. You will have them for breakfast. Screaming devils will get you going in the morning.

As I first started finding that out, I am just teaching along as He is telling me. I am supposed to provoke you into this. If everybody starts crying on me, I am going to collapse here.

In Brazil, they were sobbing all over the front and in the crowd. He has touched me with something. You know He has. You know it is going to lead into something too, do you not?

The first time I was with my friends in Phoenix, the pastor's wife had trouble. The meeting was over, and the gift of my office had lifted off of me. I was in the back room fellowshiping, dead-weight tired.

The pastor's wife came back and said, "I cannot bend my thumb."

I reached up, and I knew the difference. The anointing came from the washroom and filled the place. I reached over, got her thumb, and prayed, and it straightened out.

Then a seventeen-year-old blind boy, the elder's son from the same church, got down on his knees in front of me, and God opened his eye. It was the anointing of the believer again. I thought, "My God."

In our camp meeting, Larry came in with their son Jay. He had come through the office and pulled tendons off his feet, and he was hobbling on a crutch. He sat down, and I got down to pray. No sooner had I gotten on my knees than the anointing of the believer filled the room.

I grabbed him by the foot, and I could feel the fire. I had not quite figured it out yet, but I left him sitting in the chair and said, "You are healed."

I went back and Larry and I were talking. I was sitting on the couch, Larry was over there, and Jay was sitting in the chair. I was looking at Larry while talking. Larry had that blank stare that a lot of people get when I talk, staring off into the future.

All of a sudden, his mouth dropped open and his eyes got real big. I thought, "What is wrong with him?" I could tell I had lost him. Jay was in his line of sight. Jay got up, the one who had hobbled in on crutches, and just walked off.

I was finding out there was healing in that presence, along with everything else, because it is something that belongs to the believer, not to my office.

Never had I seen it operate as much as in those three weeks I was gone before I headed for Brazil. One week was an extension because I could not stop. I saw miracles like that.

Let me tell you a little more about that anointing of the believer.

In the six weeks when I was at Normal and could not come home, meeting after meeting, we sent six major miracles back to Lee College.

Brad was having a heart attack. His left side was going numb and hurting terribly. He called me on my cell phone after a morning meeting and said, "I am having a heart attack."

I said, "Glory to God. Raise your hands."

The anointing of the believer came on both of us. He almost ran off the road and went into hilarious laughter. I thought there was no use trying to talk to him. The only thing he could say was, "All the pain is gone. Everything is gone."

He pulled over and laughed for fifteen minutes before he could get back on the road.

When I got home, I heard the rest of the story. It all left, every bit of it. He went home and caught up on well-needed sleep. He slept for twelve hours straight. Something switched. He could not sleep twelve hours straight if you paid him. He was too full of responsibility. Not that he was full of worry, but those pressures presented themselves.

That is what keeps a man from sleep.

Any God who can go from Cleveland, Tennessee, over a wire and take your heart attack away in the middle of driving, when you are an accountable elder, is some kind of God.

When I got home and heard the rest of the story, he was leaning against my truck. His cell rang. It was Denise. I got on the phone to say hi, because he wanted me to pray for Emily.

All of a sudden I said, "Denise, do you need healing or something?"

She said, "Well, yes. We just discovered a lump in my breast about the size of a thumb."

I said, "Which hand do you have the phone in, girl?"

She said, "My left."

I said, "Then raise your other one."

No sooner had she gotten it up than the anointing of the believer filled the truck. Brad said he fell backward a little. She was hilariously laughing on the other end of the phone.

When we got control again, I said, "All right, put your finger on it."

She put her thumb on the growth, and of course it disappeared underneath her thumb. She felt it go.

Then I went back up, and the New York ladies were listening to these things on tape. You know the New York ladies. They had a seventy-year-old, seventy-pound friend who was dying in the last stages of cancer and getting transfusions.

I got up to Gatlinburg, and they came in the first day saying, "Our friend... We came the first day because we want to put you on the phone with her."

I said, "What is the matter?"

"Seventy pounds, blood transfusions, lying on the bed full of pain, dying of liver cancer."

The first day we got there, Bronk was there. After I taught, we went down to the room, called her up, and got her on the phone.

I said, "Which hand do you have the phone in? Raise the other one."

She did, and then she burst into hilarious laughter. I was trying to talk to her and could not. Finally I just gave the phone back to the New York ladies and said, "She is healed."

They could not get through for two or three more days. When they finally got her, she said, "No, you do not understand. I was seventy pounds, and now all the pain is gone. Do you understand? I have been in pain so long, and it is gone. I am losing it."

Then a preacher came. How many remember I was at Elaine's for three days just before Gatlinburg? A preacher came to Elaine's, and we prayed over a cloth. He brought it back to his friend. The man's cancer was in his liver, and his liver was so full of it that he was already getting cold because his circulation was shutting down. He was very, very cold on a life machine.

They laid the cloth on him, and this preacher testified that when they laid it on him, his temperature came up.

You have to understand Paul. He was not showing off. From one place, he reached all of Asia Minor. All the villages could not come and listen to him, although he received all who came. Finally Paul said, "Wait a minute." He started praying over cloths to send them back.

The people did not have faith when the messengers went, although they had seen everything. But they would bring back the cloth and say, "This man prayed over this cloth." Then they would start laying them on people in their villages. They were receiving Jesus, outstanding creative miracles were taking place, devils were crying out, and healings were happening.

Why? Because they understood that if they were tangibly in touch with that man, they would carry a miracle back. That is where their faith was.

By the time the man who brought the cloth to the sick man got to Gatlinburg, I said, "Where is the man now?"

He said, "Right now he is mowing his lawn."

Then another lady came up at 5:23 and said, "My son turned his knee and completely wrenched it. He is facing an operation. Could I have prayer for my son?"

It was 5:23 because I looked at my watch. I said, "You are going to have to tell him what happened."

We prayed at 5:23. I said, "You are going to have to call him." She did not call because she and her husband had to leave the next day to go back home.

When they got home, she said, "How is your knee?"

He said, "Yesterday I was walking across the room, and it popped real loud and completely quit hurting."

People in the room could hear it pop.

They said, "What time was that, son?"

He said, "Oh, it was about 5:30."

That was exactly the moment we prayed. She said they took him to the doctor, and the doctor said, "I do not know about this, but he does not need an operation now. I do not know what happened."

Come on.

What have we messed up?

Were we not supposed to gather you together as pastors? Were we not supposed to avoid forsaking the assembling of ourselves together? In those days most people did not read, so they were taught firsthand. They were taught to pray in the Holy Ghost and receive their doctrine from the apostles, and they leaned heavily upon the pastors because they could not even read.

Then, especially in the early church, they went into their cities. Immediately, they broke bread from house to house.

What have we done? What have we done holed up in four walls where we conduct all our business?

I have to rethink that word or something.

I would rather have three witch doctors in a grass hut chanting against the miracle you are trying to perform, as in raising somebody from the dead. They can chant, throw their little insignias at me, throw little bags of powder, and pour it on me. It will not make any difference. Their source has been defeated.

I would rather have three of them in the room than three unbelieving believers.

Do you think the Holy Ghost is so super sensitive that chanting bothers Him? I would rather have three witch doctors than three unbelieving believers, because unbelieving believers can stop God. They do not believe.

Prayer center, be careful what you do with this.